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RE010- Consumer Behavior and Challenges in Following Dietary Restrictions

1. Introduction-

Consumer food choices are greatly influenced by dietary limitations, such as low-carb, vegan, gluten-free, or allergen-specific diets. However, due to a variety of behavioral and environmental reasons, many people find it difficult to regularly follow these diets despite growing knowledge. Designing solutions that facilitate better eating choices requires an understanding of these issues.

2. Dietary Restrictions' Effect on Consumer Decisions

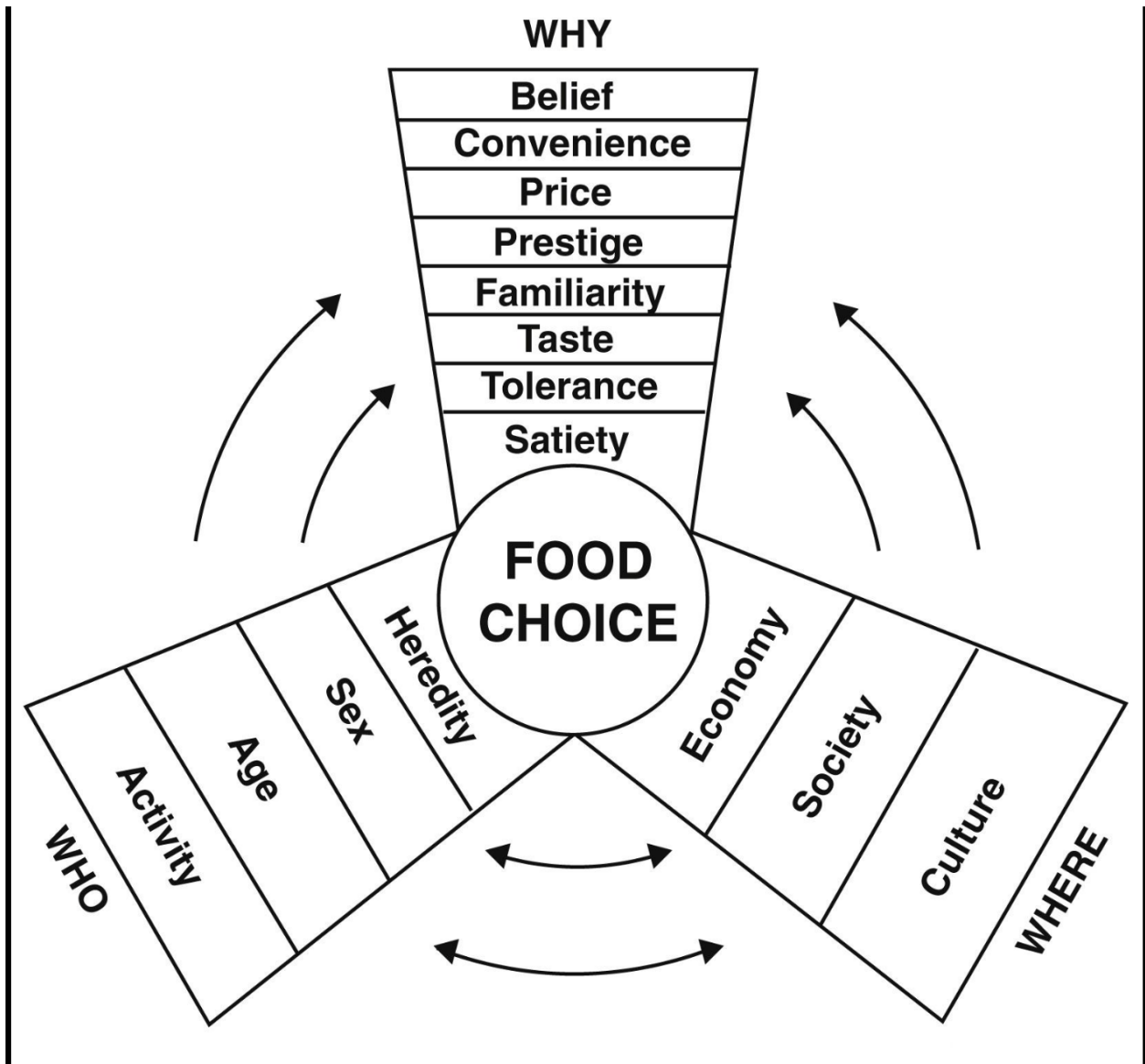
Dietary limitations have a direct impact on how consumers assess and choose food items. Customers frequently give priority to:

- a) Transparency of ingredients
- b) Nutritiousness
- c) Conformity to dietary objectives

Making decisions isn't always logical, though. Many users depend on:

- a) Fast heuristics, such as "low calories = healthy"
- b) Brand trust rather than in-depth research
- c) Convenience rather than rigorous adherence

As a result, there is a discrepancy between intended and actual behavior.

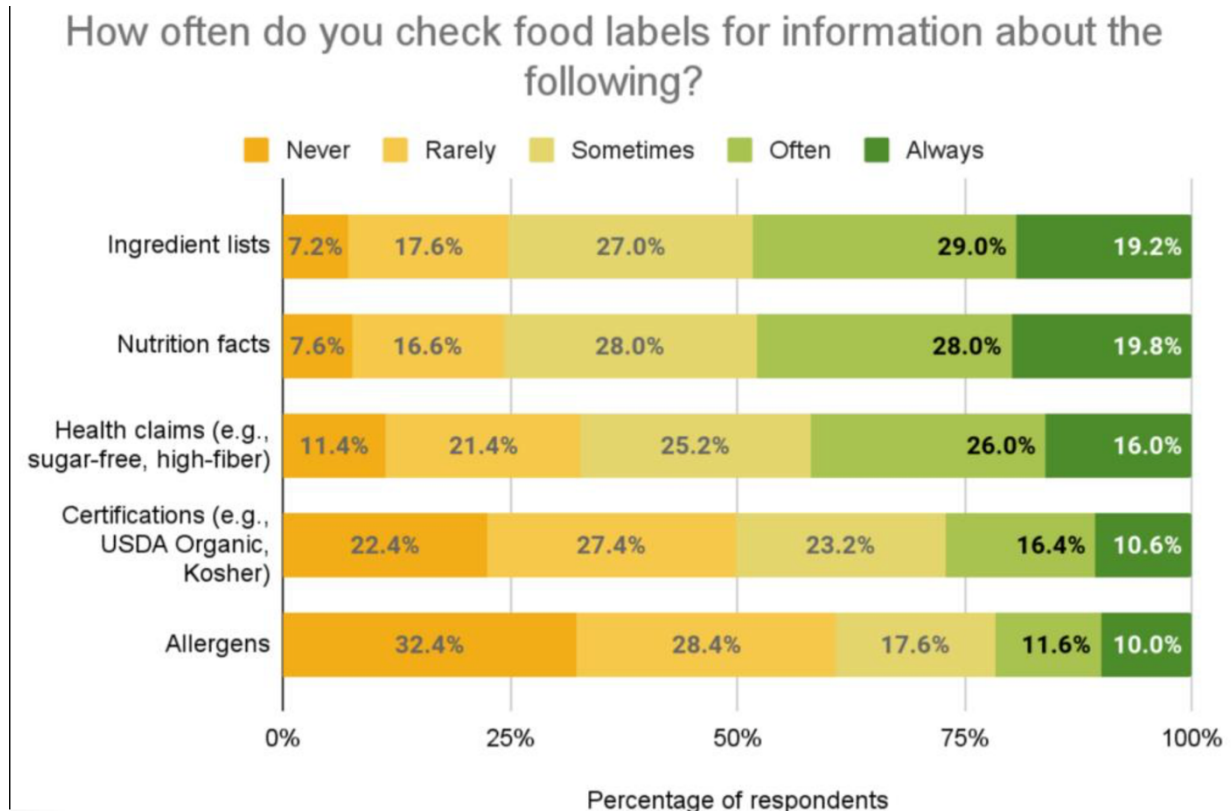


3. Key challenges faced by customers

When attempting to adhere to dietary limitations, consumers encounter a number of interrelated problems, the most important of which are accessibility, affordability, and information clarity. Finding appropriate food options can be difficult for many users, and the cost of specialized or healthier items frequently affects their decision to buy. Furthermore, confusing or deceptive ingredient labels make it challenging for consumers to determine food compatibility. Time constraints and a lack of nutritional awareness exacerbate these problems, causing customers to put convenience ahead of dietary objectives. As a result, many users are unable to successfully adhere to their



dietary limitations, and there is a persistent discrepancy between desired behavior and actual choices.



4. Impact of Awareness on Decision-Making

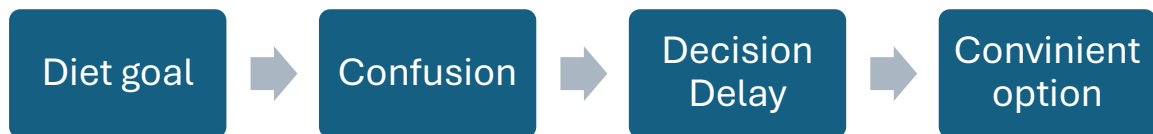
Food choices are significantly influenced by consumer awareness. Higher nutritional awareness increases the likelihood that people will read labels, assess substances, and make choices that support their dietary objectives. But awareness by itself does not ensure greater results. Many users suffer from information overload, which causes confusion and delays in making decisions due to an abundance of nutritional facts. In these situations, users are more likely to depend on simplified cues or make routine decisions. This shows that while awareness enhances intention, efficient systems must also make information simpler in order to facilitate prompt and precise decision-making.

5. Real-World Difficulties in Maintaining Dietary Restrictions

Maintaining dietary limitations might be difficult in real-world situations because of lifestyle and environmental influences. Reliance on ready-to-eat, convenient foods



that may not meet dietary requirements is encouraged by hectic schedules. Decisions are also influenced by social circumstances, such as dining out or in a group, which frequently cause people to compromise their dietary rules. Additionally, it is challenging for users to maintain consistency over time in the absence of individualized counsel and ongoing support. These difficulties demonstrate that dietary adherence is a behavioral and situational issue in addition to a knowledge issue.



6. Key Insights

Several significant discoveries are revealed by the analysis:

- a) Customers like straightforward instructions over intricate nutritional information.
- b) Cost and accessibility have a big impact on what people buy.
- c) Intention and actual decision-making consistently diverge.
- d) Instead of thorough analysis, users mostly rely on fast decision-making cues.
- e) Contextual help and personalization can greatly increase adherence.

7. Implications for System Design

The results of this study directly affect how the Food Remedy system is designed:

- a) Use transparent grading systems rather than unprocessed nutritional data.
- b) Emphasize food hazards and allergies in an easy-to-read style.
- c) Make tailored suggestions depending on user constraints and preferences.
- d) Make healthy substitution suggestions to help people make better choices.



- e) Use visual cues and streamlined insights to simplify decisions.
- f) By resolving these issues, the system will be able to assist users in making consistent and well-informed dietary decisions.